



**JPK**

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62530 PUTRAJAYA**

## **KERTAS PENERANGAN**

( INFORMATION SHEET )

|                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                   |                                        |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| <b>KOD DAN NAMA PROGRAM /</b><br><i>PROGRAM CODE AND NAME</i>              | <b>Z-009-3: 2015 CORE ABILITIES</b>                                                                                                                               |                                        |
| <b>TAHAP / LEVEL</b>                                                       | <b>3 (THREE)</b>                                                                                                                                                  |                                        |
| <b>NO. DAN TAJUK KEBOLEHAN TERAS/</b><br><i>CORE ABILITY NO. AND TITLE</i> | <b>CA05 ADMINISTRATIVE SKILL</b>                                                                                                                                  |                                        |
| <b>NO. DAN PENYATAAN KEBOLEHAN /</b><br><i>ABILITY NO. AND STATEMENT</i>   | 05.01 WORK ASSET USAGE AWARENESS<br>05.02 NEGOTIATE ACCEPTANCE AND DELIVERY OF PRODUCTS AND /OR SERVICES<br><b>05.03 IMPLEMENT WORK FORCE RESOURCES PRACTICES</b> |                                        |
| <b>NO. KOD / CODE NO.</b>                                                  | <b>Z-009-3:2015-M05/P(3/3)</b>                                                                                                                                    | Mukasurat / Page : 1<br>Drpd / of : 23 |

**TAJUK / TITLE: HUMAN RESOURCES PLANNING**

### **TUJUAN / OBJECTIVE:**

The person who is competent in this CA shall be able to implement work force resources practices. Upon completion of this competency unit trainees will be able to handle Work Force Resources And Planning.

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## **PENERANGAN / INFORMATION :**

### **1. HUMAN RESOURCE PLANNING**

The purpose of human resource planning is to ensure that a certain desired number of persons with the correct skills are available at the right time. Recruitment done with no proper planning may end up with excess or shortage of manning levels.

#### **1.1 Forecasting Demand for Human Resource**

It is the duty of human resource department to plan and manage sufficient man power for the job. There are two aspects of planning, namely long term and short term of manning level.

In Malaysia, it is very common to short term forecasting to meeting the company's objectives, even though they fully understand the necessity of having long term planning of their human resources. Very few actually do it.

##### **i) Long Term Forecasting of Human Resource Requirements**

Long term human resource planning is part of the organization strategic plans. Though forecasts of human resource requirements over five years are mere projections which may not be accurate, long term forecasting of two to five years is necessary to ensure that the company's objectives are achieved.

Knowledge of the organization's long term corporate plans is essential so that it can be managed for the future needs of human resources

Human resource planners should also be aware that advances in technology have definite effects on the demand for jobs in terms of nature and mixture of jobs availability. Advances in technology has resulted a decrease in the number of workers. New machines lead to higher productivity. At the same time it decreases in demand for manpower. For example, the use of robots may result in the loss of certain manual jobs.

##### **ii) Short Term Forecasting of Human Resource Requirements**

Even though many organizations have started the practice of long term planning, there is still a need for short term planning as the human resource department

requires some lead time to revert the needed planning schedule.

In certain discipline, the forecasts for the coming years must be translated into production plans and schedules. The problem is to obtain accurate production quotas and projection of sales. Once the sales forecast and budget are determined, then production schedules can be ascertained. Finally the human resource requirements are established.

Various techniques and models can be used to make these projections.

### iii) Resources Supply Forecasting

In projecting future supply of human resources, the first step is to take into account is the current inventory. Human resource records should be summarized in a systematic manner and stored in such an easily retrieved. Having it done that way the special skills or proficiencies available in various jobs and departments within the organization are identified. For example, in a large organization of 5000 people, anyone should be able to find out if there are Spanish speaking engineers available, and if so how many are there.

Projections of future human resource needs are usually referred to the past records. Technological improvements, however, will increase the productivity levels of the work force. Therefore, there is a need to study productivity trends to determine changes in productivity level in order to reduce surplus of man power without affecting production lines.

Staff turnover refers to the number of employees who leave the organization for some reason or other. For example, we have 1000 employees at the beginning of the month. No one can assure the number remains by the month end. There may be retirements, deaths, resignations, or even dismissals. Retirements are predictable, but other turnover must be determined by looking at past trends to obtain an average turnover rate. Turnover will result in a temporary shortage of employees because it will usually take some times for a replacement. The turnover rate is computed as follows:

$$\text{Turnover Rate} = \frac{\text{Number of employees who}}{\text{Average number of employees}} \times 100$$

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Absenteeism occurs when a person fails to report for work as per scheduled plan. It is usually measured as a percentage of scheduled time lost and is computed as follows:

$$A = \frac{(\text{Number of man-days lost})}{(\text{Average number of person absent}) \times (\text{Number of working days})} \times 100$$

The absenteeism will reduce the number of personnel actually available for work. If the absenteeism rate among 1000 employees is 2 percent, this means that on the average only 980 people are present and ready for work.

Another aspect of human resource supply forecasting is the fact that some jobs serve as sources of supply for other jobs. For example, there might be needs for promotions in the future and the average developmental time for a manager is five years. In that case we may need more than three potential candidates because at times we should bear in mind that the promoted personnel will also needs replacements..

## **1.2 Human Resource Actions**

Human resource actions are vital whenever demand for human resources does not match the supply. The human resource department should manage the situation efficiently.

When there are vacancies, replacement can be done either through new recruitments or a priority be given to qualified serving staff. Or alternatively the management may opt for overtime works to existing staff or put a strict control on absenteeism.

### **i) Actions To Take When A Vacancy Occurs**

When a vacancy occurs, especially in a management job, firstly examine the reasons for the vacancy. Do not haste in filling it up. An objective evaluation may save time and effort and help avoiding further expenses, disturbances or disruptions due to recruitment and selection. The most common reasons for a vacancy to occur are resignations, dismissals or new positions.

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If the vacancy is due to a resignation, an exit interview should be conducted to find out the reasons. Management must decide as to whether the resignation was desirable or not, whether the person who left represents a great loss to the organization or was it a case of 'good riddance to bad rubbish'? Some big organizations, do not mind losing young workers, but they of course would hope to retain the best of these personnel. Because of their size, they would usually have a pool of replacement workers and they would be constantly recruiting and grooming for more. Smaller organizations, however, do not have this luxury and would have a problem whenever a person leaves. If management feels that the resignation represents a big loss, then the appropriate actions before recruitment is to examine the reasons for resignation and take necessary actions to prevent such occurrences.

If the vacancy was due to an undesirable person being dismissed or forced to leave, again there is a need for analysis. It is obvious that a mistake was made in the first place and this analysis should be aimed at finding out the reason for the mistake. It could be due to the appointment of a square peg in a round hole due to educational background, personality, incompatibility with co-workers or bosses, or other reasons. The important point here is not to go on a witch-hunt but to objectively conduct an analysis so as not to repeat the mistake.

A thorough analysis of human resource requirements should be conducted before a new vacancy is approved. Getting a new person in is easy compared to getting a person out of the organization. It would be a shame to hire a new person and find that there is not enough work for him or her to do, or to find that the work was only for a temporary period.

If the result is that hiring of new staff is required then the next step is to conduct the recruitment and selection process. However, before conducting the recruitment and selection process we must obtain information as to what the job involves and what type of person is suitable for the job. This can be obtained from a job analysis.

### **1.3 Job Analysis**

Job analysis is the most basic human resource tool. It is the systematic process of studying and collecting information relating to the operations and responsibilities of a

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specific job. It is an essential human resource duty and one of the first duties that needs to be performed by the resource department. The main products of job analysis are Job Descriptions and Job Specifications.

i) **Job Description**

A job description is a document that provides information regarding the tasks, duties, and responsibilities of a particular job. It is an organized, factual statement of the duties and responsibilities of the job

ii) **Job Specification**

A job specification is a statement of the minimum acceptable human qualities necessary to perform a job properly. Where the job description describes the job, the job specification is a standard of personnel and designates the qualities required for acceptable performance.

iii) **Job Analysis Process**

The process of analyzing a job is essentially one of data collection. A substantial amount of information is required for successful accomplishment of job analysis. The job is first studied to determine the tasks to be performed, the duties, and the responsibilities. This information is then used to decide the level of knowledge, skills and abilities required for a person to perform the job efficiently.

Other aspects of the job, such as tools, equipment or materials used, the products made, or the services performed are then looked into. Since jobs are often performed in conjunction with others in an organization, the relationships of work flow and procedures, as well as lines of promotion are also studied.

In some organizations, the job analysis process also determines job standards. It involves the measurement of time taken to perform a task, or the output quantity per time period.

Various approaches can be used in job analysis depending on the organizational needs and resources for conducting the task. Selection of a method depends on the information to be used and its practicality.

Usually, the job analyst uses more than one method of analysis. For recruitment and selection of management jobs, the most popular approaches are questionnaires and interviews. Observations and interviews are for skilled manual

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jobs.

Interviews are applicable for supplementary information. Observation is seldom used for management jobs because it is difficult to observe a function of a manager. A manager may appear to be sitting down doing nothing but in actual fact he might be thinking or planning on something.

In analyzing production or skilled jobs, it will be much easier to acquire true information by the interview and observation.

#### iv) **Job Description**

The information obtained from the job analysis is crucial for developing job description. The job description is the first product of analysis exercise. It is descriptive document containing particulars about the job but it must be organized in a proper manner for effective applications.

The format of job description varies depending on the organization. The following order may be used as a guide: -

- a) Job identification
- b) Job summary
- c) Duties performed
- d) Supervision given
- e) Relation to other jobs
- f) Tools, equipment and materials
- g) Working conditions
- h) Definitions of unusual terms
- i) Additional comments
- j) Date of the Job Analysis

#### v) **Job Specification**

The job specification is a document containing minimum acceptable qualifications that a person should possess to perform a particular job. Information usually found in a job specification includes educational credentials, work experiences, physical abilities and sometimes even personality traits. After the analyst has prepared the job specification, he should review it with the right supervisors.

In some organizations, the job specification forms part of the job description and

both documents are considered to be merged. Preparing a job specification is relatively simple but there could be considerable disagreement over the requirements for the works. One way is to classify each requirement into mandatory or desirable. A mandatory requirement becomes a compulsory attribute that candidates must possess whereas a desirable requirement means something that is nice to have but not compulsory. Mandatory requirements can be either readily possessed from the beginning or can be developed after on the job. If the requirement is desirable, then it must go with the level of importance.

A sample job specification form is shown below:

| <b>SAMPLE JOB SPECIFICATION</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                 |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| <b>JOB TITLE</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | : SALES MANAGER |
| <b>DEPARTMENT</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | : SALES         |
| <b>MANDATORY REQUIREMENTS</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                 |
| <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>1. Degree in business administration</li> <li>2. 5 years experience in sales, at least 2 years in furniture trade</li> <li>3. Malaysian citizen</li> <li>4. Age above 30</li> <li>5. Ability to speak fluently in English and Bahasa Melayu</li> </ol> |                 |
| <b>DESIRABLE REQUIREMENTS</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                 |
| <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>1. Master's degree in Business Administration</li> <li>2. Experienced in using personal computers</li> </ol>                                                                                                                                           |                 |

Figure. 1: Sample Job Specification Form

## **2. RECRUITMENT AND SELECTION**

In many cases, recruitment and selection are combined and called employment function. It is under the jurisdiction of human resource department. Hiring is actually referring to both the recruitment and selection process. For a better comprehension the procedures of recruitment and selection, we refer to the definition and differences between the two terminologies.

### **2.1 Recruitment**

Recruitment is the process of finding and attracting capable applicants and encouraging

them to apply for the employment. The process begins when eligible individuals are sought and ends after their applications are submitted. Recruitment results in a pool of applicants from which the potential candidates are selected. Thus, the recruitment process may be regarded as a positive course of action in obtaining as many suitable candidates as possible.

The recruitment process can be illustrated as follows:

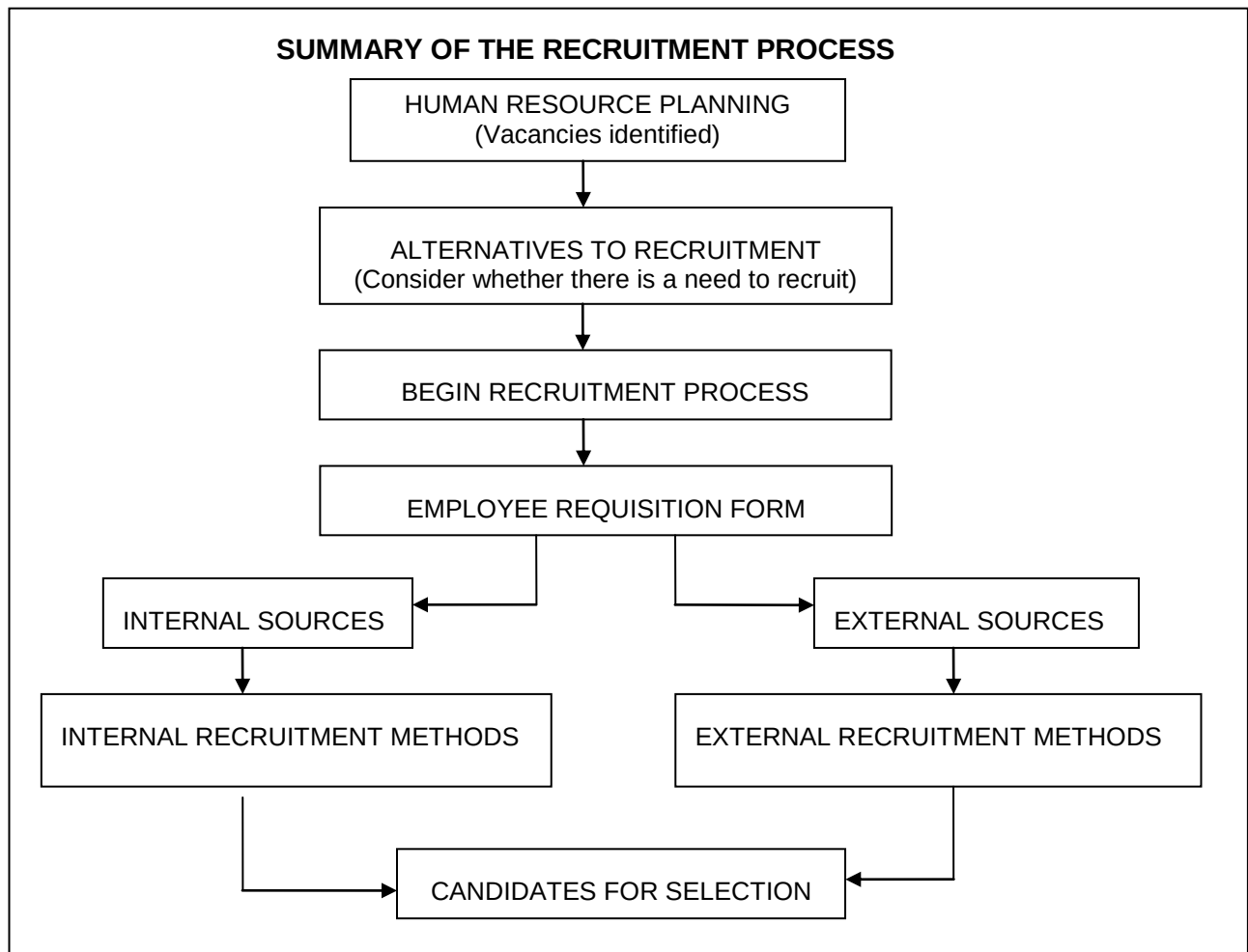


Figure. 2: Summary of Recruitment Process

## 2.2 Selection

Selection is the process of choosing best suited candidate for the position. The selection process begins after the recruitment process creates a pool of suitable applicants. On the other hand, the selection process may be considered as negative action as it involves reducing the applicants to the most appropriate number. A series of steps involves in selection process to ensure correct hiring decision is done.

There are nine steps of selection process to follow before final decision is made in hiring

a candidate.

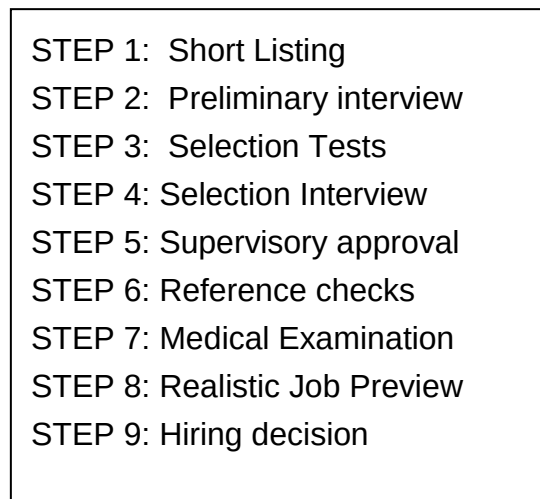


Figure 3: The Selection Process

### 3. THE IMPORTANCE OF RECRUITMENT AND SELECTION

One of the most important functions in human resource management is the recruitment and selection of people. Proper and effective recruitment and selection techniques will ensure that the company hires only competent, motivated and productive employees.

There are cases whereby this process is left in the hands of unfamiliar personnel to make appropriate decisions. As a result, many hiring process were wrongly decided. When recruitment and selection is not properly managed, it may lead to hiring of non-conformist employee who will eventually end up with resignation or be terminated within short period of service. Or else they are kept back as non performer workers.

There is no fast and hard rule to prevent mistakes during recruitment and selection process. To minimize such erroneous decision and progress with hiring the most appropriate candidates strictly stick to the techniques and steps of recruitment and selection process.

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#### **4. ALTERNATIVES TO RECRUITMENT**

Recruitment of employees is a tough work. Recruitment and selection costs are high and the costs of maintaining the employees are also high. Employees' cost keep escalating as they will get their annual increment and other adjustments to salaries as well as increases in fringe benefits. Furthermore, once employees are hired and placed on the payroll, they become difficult and costly to remove. The employment act is enacted to protect the rights of employees and prevent them from being exploited or victimized by the employers.

Due to the above hectic reasons, the organization should have the right consideration before adding up personnel to the payroll. There are various alternatives to substitute recruitment.

##### **4.1 Overtime**

Many organizations use overtime to compensate short term fluctuations in work volume. The overtime is considered as a common practice nowadays and is advantageous to both parties on win-win situation.

The disadvantages on overtime are that it may create loopholes for employees to go on slow work so as to earn extra overtime pay. Also when overtime work stops, the employees will face stress due to income reduction. As a result they become de-motivated and their productivity drops.

Too much overtime work may also cause fatigue and exhaustion to the employees and becoming less productive. The fact is, some managers estimate that the productivity rate from an employee who works on overtime after his regular shift-work may produce only about two-thirds of his normal output. The overtime rates normally disburse no less than one and one half (1½) times the ordinary pay rate, but in return the employer gets only two-thirds of the normal work output.

##### **4.2 Subcontracting**

Some organizations farm-out their works as an alternative to recruitment of staff, especially in situations of temporary demand for human resource. This is because subcontracting is generally advantageous for both parties.

Two opposing situations exist when subcontracting the organizations' work.

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- i) If the types of work to be carried out requires no skill at all, and the organization pays above average wages and does not wish to keep unskilled employees on its payroll.
- ii) If the works require specialized skills and the subcontractor can offer such capable employees for the job.

### **4.3 Temporary employees**

To maintain flexibility in situation of varying workloads, many organizations use short-term employees. These employees are normally hired for fixed periods and leave the services after the job is completed. Provisional staff is mainly hired for temporary job or as a relieved to female staff going on maternity leave.

### **4.4 Employee leasing**

Another way of getting temporary workers in the market is employee leasing. There are a number of manpower leasing companies actively operational in the country. They are set up to assist the industry in handling their excess or special workloads.

The difference between this type of employee and temporary employees is that the employees are employed by the manpower suppliers and are on their payroll. The hirer pays the bill to the leasing company and not the workers' salary.

## **5. STAFF TRAINING**

Employers should have clear goals for the training function in their organization. These goals include:

- i) Assisting employees in developing the skills and knowledge needed to perform effectively in their current jobs.
- ii) Preparing employees to take on a variety of jobs as and when required.
- iii) Helping employees develop and achieve their potential.

Many organizations survive without offering any training to their employees. They believe that training is a waste of time and money. They might have gone through negative experiences with training in the past. Alternatively, they are willing to buy in employees

with the skills and knowledge needed to run their businesses. However, these firms will never be the front runners in the industry. They are not the market leaders and their long-term survival may be at risk.

Training is part of employment process to cope up with technological advancements and can be scheduled internally or with external organizers. Workers who are not kept abreast of changes in the business environment will soon find themselves redundant and of little value to the employer. Yet, as the labor market gets tighter and social disapproval of retrenchment increases, the employers hold the market. The only answer is for employees to be trained and retrained throughout their careers. It is the employer who must initiate to organize suitable training programs for their workers.

Training is an investment. The plan differs from one organization to another, basically depending on their needs and budgets. At different periods a company may spend more on training or reduce it. For instance, in times of high labor turnover, more training needs to be spent on new recruits.

Some companies have a written policy on training which declares their commitments to training and developing employees. Naturally, it is essential that, once such a policy has been communicated to employees, the management implements the policy consistently.

A training policy may be expressed as in the following example:

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p><b><u>SAMPLE TRAINING POLICY</u></b></p> <p>Syarikat ABC Sdn Bhd is fully committed providing training for all its employees so that they can maximize their productivity. We also believe in developing our people so that they can achieve their potential.</p> <p>All managers are responsible for ensuring that their subordinates receive the necessary training in a timely and cost-efficient manner. Every employee is expected to cooperate fully in every training program which he or she is required to attend.</p> <p>To ensure the company's goal of having a pool of trained workforce is met, every employee is required to attend a minimum of 40 hours training per year.</p> |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

Figure 4: Sample of Training Policy

Those companies which are required to contribute to the Human Resource Development Fund automatically have a minimum budget for training – at the least the amount that

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they can expect to get by way of reimbursement from the Fund. Others may set a higher figure.

Training programs, methodology and topics are depending on the skill and job nature of the participants. The trainers have the prerogative on the choice of the most appropriate technology for any given training sessions. Planning, implementation and evaluation of the training still require the same amount of thought and preparation.

## **6. IDENTIFYING TRAINING NEEDS**

Training programs need to be carefully and thoroughly planned. To do this, the trainer should evaluate and determine the answers to a number of key questions, such as:

- i) Why is training needed?
- ii) To whom is the training to be offered?
- iii) What is the nature of the problem to which training is to be the answer?
- iv) Who is to facilitate the training program?
- v) What is the specific objective of the training?
- vi) What is the expected duration of the training?
- vii) When should the training be held?
- viii) Where is the training to be held?
- ix) What training methods could be used?

### **6.1 Training Needs Analysis (TNA)**

It is necessary to conduct a training needs analysis (TNA) before identifying which employees need the training and what sort of training they required. This is an ongoing process. A needs analysis may vary depending on category and level of employees to undergo a particular kind of training to develop cultural norms, cohesiveness amongst workers, and commitment to the company's vision and goals.

Individual's needs must also be examined to see whether training will assist employees to improve their performance. Various sources of information will be used to collect information for analysis including:

- a) Questionnaires issued to managers asking them to identify the training needs of their subordinates.

- b) Questionnaires issued to employees asking them to identify the training courses they think helpful in their daily functions.
- c) Data in job descriptions.
- d) Performance appraisal forms which identify individual training needs.
- e) Company records and reports.

#### i) Questionnaires

Job-related skills differ between one industry and another. These generic skills can be listed in questionnaires forms to be filled up by respective superiors and respondents. Different lists are prepared for the various groups of employees. Not all employees will absorb the same skill and not everyone will attend the training. Below are samples of a Survey Form. Questionnaires for employees which match the categories of survey could be drafted as follows:

| <b>Training Needs for Management Staff Survey Form</b>                                                                                                             |                           |            |            |            |            |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
| <i>Instructions to managers;</i> Please tick in the appropriate column if you believe the employee concerned needs to undergo any of the listed training programs. |                           |            |            |            |            |
| <b>SKILL</b>                                                                                                                                                       | <b>NAMES OF EMPLOYEES</b> |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                    | <b>“A”</b>                | <b>“B”</b> | <b>“C”</b> | <b>“D”</b> | <b>“E”</b> |
| Telephone Techniques                                                                                                                                               |                           |            |            |            |            |
| Spoken English                                                                                                                                                     |                           |            |            |            |            |
| Written English                                                                                                                                                    |                           |            |            |            |            |
| Computer Skills                                                                                                                                                    |                           |            |            |            |            |
| ✓ MSWord                                                                                                                                                           |                           |            |            |            |            |
| ✓ Excel                                                                                                                                                            |                           |            |            |            |            |

Figure 5: Sample Survey Form for Managers

| <b>Training Needs For Clerical Staff Survey Form</b> |                                                                                                                    |
|------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <i>Instructions to employees:</i>                    |                                                                                                                    |
| Please tick the correct boxes to indicate            |                                                                                                                    |
| i)                                                   | Whether the skills or knowledge area listed is relevant to accomplish your job                                     |
| ii)                                                  | Rank its importance on a scale of 1 to 5 whereby 1 indicates Not Important at All and 5 to indicate Very Important |
| iii)                                                 | Rank your own competence on each skill using the same rating of 1 - 5                                              |

| SKILL                                  | RELEVANCE | IMPORTANCE | COMPETENCE |
|----------------------------------------|-----------|------------|------------|
| Telephone Techniques                   |           |            |            |
| Spoken English                         |           |            |            |
| Written English                        |           |            |            |
| Computer Skills<br>✓ MSWord<br>✓ Excel |           |            |            |

Fig. 6 :Fig. 6 Sample Survey Form for Employees

Before constructing survey form, the employer needs to conduct a thorough job analysis first. The job description of each category in the organization must clearly specify the duties of the job-holder. From this listing, the skills and abilities to do a good job can be deduced.

There might be mismatches between the observations of a manager and that of the subordinates themselves. In such situations, the manager and the subordinate, need to sit together to confer the differences.

## ii) Company Records

Other than issuing questionnaires to the managers and employees respectively, the trainer may examine their existing records, reports and relevant documents. Trend analysis of these records may reveal that training or re-training is necessary. If possible the records should be benchmarked against other companies in the same industry or in the neighborhood. The most useful records for this purpose are as follows:

### TYPE OF RECORD

- Production output
- Sales
- Reject / error / mistakes
- Safety

### QUESTION TO ASK

- Is it decreasing?
- Are they decreasing?
- Are they increasing
- Are accidents increasing?

In some cases, it is obvious the company makes the training is compulsory. For

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example, most new employees need training even if they may have had acquired some working exposures. Those employees who are readily groomed for promotion will need an organized training program which will provide them with the exposure they need prior to promotion. Whenever there are new machinery, equipment or procedures are introduced a group of workers will need to undergo familiarization training.

There are cases of problem faced by a manager in relation to under-performing subordinates. Proper analysis is required as to whether training is the best solution. Not all problems can be resolved efficiently via training. Sometimes, there are other simpler solutions available.

In some companies, planning of training is poor or non-existent at all. They normally leave the training matters to the employees to manage it themselves. The company just provides financial supports to meet the expenses and charges incurred.

It would be tolerable if training matters are to be dealt with by respective employees had it be a one off entry and not in the management's schedules. In general this type of training is classified as a complementary to the staff concerned.

## **6.2 Determining To Whom the Training Should Be Offered To**

Training program normally intended after receiving the result of Training Needs Analysis (TNA) exercise. It could be for grooming the existing staff or in preparation for future tasks expected to be assigned to them. The TNA must identify:

- i) The expected number of participants who need training
- ii) The educational levels of the trainees
- iii) The language abilities of the trainees
- iv) The working experience and position in the organization of the trainees

This information will assist the trainer in making decisions on the content of the program, types of material and methods of instruction to be used. It will also affect the notes and handouts to be prepared.

The more the trainer knows about the trainees the better it will be. In many cases the TNA is not conducted by the trainer. In such situations the trainer has to be very cautious in preparing training materials. Not all work-related problems can be resolved by means of training. If the trainer believes that training is not the right answer to the problem, it

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would be unethical to proceed with the training anyway. He should work it out with the management to discuss the matter and look for an alternative and more workable solution.

Managers and employers often have unrealistic expectations of training. Not only do they think training should answer all their problems but they also believe that trainers can create miracles.

### **6.3 Determining Who Is To Facilitate the Training**

Training can be conducted by:

- i) Full-time trainers employed by the company who do nothing but organize and conduct training.
- ii) Senior and experienced staff who, on occasions, are required to share their knowledge and skill with their colleagues.
- iii) Free-lance training consultants and vendors who either conduct training themselves or source it to someone who will do it for them.

Generally, large companies with thousands of workers find it economical to employ full-time trainers. Even that it may still be necessary occasionally hire external trainers or consultants for the programs rarely offered.

Where a very specialized or specific training is considered necessary, the best trainers will be selected from serving employees who are amongst top performers. In that case, it is vital that these 'part-time' internal trainers undergo a thorough 'Train the Trainer' course to ensure they are proficient enough in conducting trainings.

In various circumstances, internal workforce makes the best trainers. No one else could compete their comprehensive understanding of the company's problems, procedures, requirements and restrictions.

Selecting an external training provider is not an easy task. Again you have to pick up preferences. Do you want to enter into a long-term relationship with the vendor who will provide most, if not all, your training needs? If the expert cannot facilitate a particular program you ask for, they will look for necessary replacement for it.

Apart from cost, a number of bits and pieces need to be agreed upon with the consultant.

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Here is a checklist of issues to be discussed before signing the contract:

- i) Who will conduct the annual training needs analysis – the consultant or the company?
- ii) What programs are to be offered by the consultant?
- iii) Where will programs be conducted?
- iv) What is the maximum number of participants per program?
- v) What facilities and equipment will be provided by the company?
- vi) Who will prepare stationery, including files and who will make copies of notes and other handouts for distribution to trainees?
- vii) In the event the consultant cancels the program due to unforeseen circumstances, will it be replaced at latter date?
- viii) When will payment to be made?
- ix) If the company is not in favor with the standard of the programs, how about the notice to terminate the contract?
- x) What are the company's rights to cease facilitators functions if their presentations are not to standard?
- xi) Who will evaluate each program – the consultant or the company

Inviting a consultant to conduct training programs at your place would be reasonable if you have sufficient number of participants. If you have only one or two of them it would be more practical to send them out. There are plentiful of training bodies conducting courses relevant to your needs.

## **7. SETTING OBJECTIVES FOR A TRAINING PROGRAM**

### **7.1 The Need of Training**

The Training Needs Analysis (TNA) not limited to identifying which employees need training alone, but also to determine a broad rationale for the training.

### **7.2 Overall Purpose of Training Program**

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### **Example One:**

A new technology has been introduced by the management. The workforce needs to be exposed and get them familiarized with the system. The general purpose of the training is therefore to ensure the employees are able to utilize the new gadgets and acquainted with new system.

### **Example Two:**

Newly recruited personnel have no knowledge of industrial relations as his previous employments were in different sectors. These officers could be sent to a public program to get them exposed in basic procedures and legislative of the subject. The general purpose of this training is to provide the understanding of basic laws and procedures relevant to the industry.

Training could not be evaluated unless its objectives are clearly identified and spelt out. The training objectives become the benchmark and reference in deciding whether or not the program is to be run. Normally training objectives focus at the performance and behavior expected to transform the trainee at the end of the program.

## **8. DECIDING ON THE DURATION, TIMING, AND VENUE**

### **8.1 Duration of programs**

The duration of the training program is determined by the scope of coverage. However do not take too lightly on matters related to endurance and physical and mental stamina of the participants. The most common practice and to have an effective session, a three day course would be pleasant.

Two-way participative programs, where inputs from trainees are called for, will extend the interval fairly longer period.

### **8.2 Timing of Program**

If programs are conducted outside normal office hours some other problems may pop-up. There will be refusal due to other personnel commitments. Giving sufficient notice may help. Trainees may reschedule their daily routines. On personal interest, trainees feel that they should be rewarded for extending extra hours for the sessions.

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Training schedules are planned based on weekly and calendar months. Make an effort to avoid Fridays because of the long midday break for Muslim prayer. Watch for public holidays and festivity holidays as most employees go on long leave. Another consideration is on the company's own calendar of events.

### **8.3 Training Venues**

The choice of venues will depend on factors such as the number of trainees, the budget available, facilities offered and the activities to be carried out during the training.

Among the site commonly used are:

- i) Dedicated training room / centre within the work premises
- ii) Meeting room at the work-site
- iii) Off –site training centre
- iv) Public premises such as hotel or conference centre

In-house premises attribute to a number of disadvantages.

- i) Trainees are easily distracted by the demands of their daily jobs. Superiors and subordinates alike may interrupt for work or personal matters.
- ii) The environment gives no sense of excitement to motivate and uphold their commitment to the program.
- iii) The training room cannot accommodate large number of trainees as well as constraint on available facilities. Not all organizations are fortunate enough to have excellent training facilities.

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**SOALAN / QUESTION:**

1. Define what is Recruitment.

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(4 marks)

2. define what is Selection.

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(4 marks)

3. What is the main purpose of Training Needs Analysis (TNA)?

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